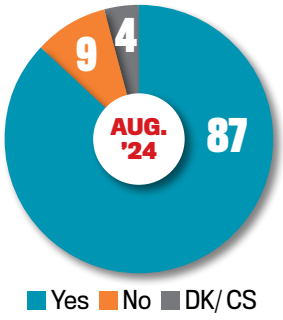


UP IN ARMS Farmers seeking legal guarantee for MSP block railway tracks in Patiala, Mar. 10

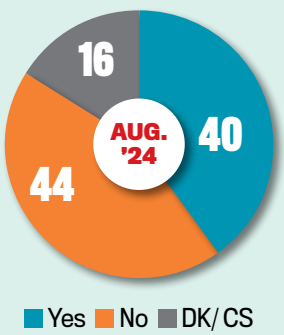
ANI

Q. Should the government legally guarantee the minimum support price (MSP) for agricultural produce?



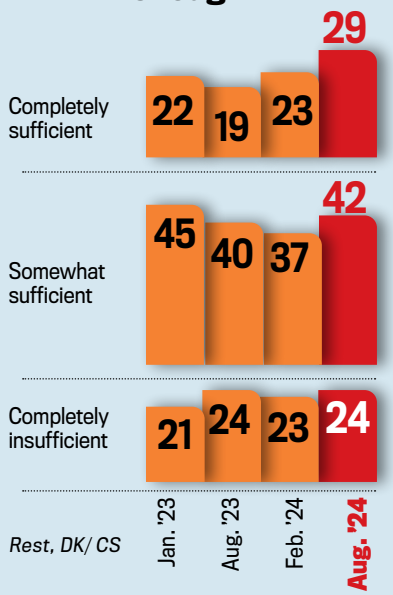
An unwavering faith in state intervention persists when it comes to the farm sector

Q. Has the Indian Railways done enough to make rail travel safe?



Opinions are sharply divided on whether the Indian Railways is doing enough to make rail travel safe

Q. Are our efforts to protect the environment enough?



All figures in % and rounded off

cost-efficient and time-saving means to conduct elections in a federal democracy like ours.

The clamour for a nationwide caste census is also getting louder, with 73.8 per cent of the respondents in its favour, as against 59.2 per cent in February. And there is a decline in those opposing it—from 27.8 per cent then to 24 per cent in the latest survey. In effect, a caste census integrated with the already delayed decadal National Census could help cut costs while generating reliable caste-wise data for policymaking.

A greater challenge, given the country's diversity, is the implementation of a Uniform Civil Code (UCC). This, even as an overwhelming 76.4 per cent of the MOTN respondents are in its favour—the highest ever in the eight polls since January 2021. Even opposition to the UCC is down at 16.1 per cent—the lowest in the past three MOTN polls—though still above the record low of 13.7 per cent in the January 2022 MOTN.

Significantly, for the first time since January 2021, the majority (50.3 per cent) does not think democracy is in danger while the percentage of those who think so has declined to 41.9—the lowest across the past eight MOTN polls. That there is greater clarity on the current state of democracy in the country becomes apparent from the fact that only 7.8 per cent of the respondents—the lowest since 2021—are uncertain or unclear about it.

Equally encouraging is that a majority of the respondents (58.9 per cent) feel free to express their opinions on politics as well as religion. It did not breach the 50 per cent mark in the earlier four surveys. Another 11.6 per cent feel free to express their opinion on politics but do not feel free to do so when it comes to religion. Yet another 7.6 per cent feel free to express their opinion on religion but not on politics. But there are still 16.5 per cent of the respondents—the highest in the past five surveys—who do not feel free on either count. That leaves just 5.4 per cent, the lowest in as many polls, who are unsure or undecided.

The perception about communal har-